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PHP

Regular Expression

Regular Expression Introduction

- Regular expressions are commonly known as **regex**.
- These are nothing more than a pattern or a sequence of characters, which describe a special search pattern as text string.
- They use arithmetic operators (+, -, ^) to create complex expressions.
- By default, regular expressions are **case sensitive**.
- PHP offers two types : POSIX and PERL



Advantages

- It helps the programmers to validate text string.
- It offers a powerful tool to analyze and search a pattern
- Widely used for browser detection, form validation, spam filtration, and password strength checking.
- It is helpful in user input validation testing like email address, mobile number, and IP address.



Operators

Op.	Description
^	It indicates the start of string.
\$	It indicates the end of the string.
.	It donates any single character.
()	It shows a group of expressions.
[]	It finds a range of characters
[^]	It finds the characters which are not in range



Character Class

RegEx	Meaning
[abc]	Matches any one of the characters a, b, or c.
[^abc]	Matches any one character other than a, b, or c.
[a-z]	Matches any one character from a-z
[A-Z]	Matches any one character from A-Z
[a-Z]	Matches any one character from a-Z
[0-9]	Matches a single digit between 0 and 9.
[a-zA-Z0-9]	Matches a single character between a and z or between 0 and 9.



Character Class

RegEx	Meaning
[a-z]+	One or more lowercase letters
[0-9.-]	Any number, dot, or minus sign
[^A-Za-z0-9]	Any symbol (not a number or a letter)
(gif jpg)	Matches either “gif” or “jpeg”

